

Tonight, I'd like to speak of courage, perseverance, and victories:

One example of courage found in history are the men who responded to this ad placed in a London Newspaper by the British Antarctic explorer Sir Ernest Shackleton:

The ad read:

Men wanted for hazardous journey: small wages, bitter cold, long months of complete darkness, constant danger, safe return doubtful. Honor and recognition in case of success.

Winston Churchill offers an example of perseverance in the face of adversity. In May of 1940, he spoke these words to the British people as the German army threatened to invade England:

He said "We shall not flag nor fail... whatever the cost may be, we shall fight on the beaches, we shall fight on the landing grounds, we shall fight in the fields and in the streets.. we shall fight in the hills; we shall never surrender."

None present tonight are on the verge of a dangerous Antarctic expedition, nor are we facing an enemy invasion, but there is a battle we each fight. This battle is of self-mastery and in order to win, we need courage and perseverance.

Plato, the Greek philosopher spoke of self-discipline when he said:

"The first and best victory is to conquer self."

Leonardo de Vinci stated:

"The height of a man's success is gauged by his self-mastery, the depth of his failure by his self-abandonment."

Although honor and recognition are not guaranteed in the case of success, the mastery of self is a battle worth winning, whatever the cost maybe.

} Farewell
} goodbye

I Express gratitude
parents teachers administrators

Regina

To the class of 1997,
goodbye and good luck